

Bloomsbury Group

In 1905, a group of artists, writers and intellectuals began meeting at the home of the artist Vanessa Bell (1879–1961) and her writer sister Virginia Woolf (1882–1941) in Bloomsbury, London. Main members of the Bloomsbury group included novelist E.M. Forster (1879–1970), art critic Clive Bell (1881–1964), painters Bell and Duncan Grant (1885–1978), economist John Maynard Keynes (1883–1946), and writers Leonard Woolf (1880–1969) and Lytton Strachey (1880–1932).

Except Duncan Grant, the male Bloomsbury Group members were educated at either Trinity or King's College, Cambridge. The Bloomsbury group had no formal philosophy, but was united in a belief in the importance of the arts and by a rejection of the restrictions of Victorian society. Unusually for the period, they were all open-minded about sexual matters. After they were joined by Roger Fry in 1910, the artists in the group began producing adventurous, richly coloured and patterned abstract and figurative paintings, which became known as Bloomsbury Style.



Grant, *Angelica Playing the Violin*, 1934